



The 'Ubuntu 10.04 Start' script

Ubuntu 10.04's April 29 release will, by the time you read this, be long past. If, like me, you prefer to install and test a new distribution release in a new partition on your hard drive, you're probably already groaning at the thought of all that installation and customisation that you will need to do. This Bash script automates much of the grunt work, and lets you choose what you want to tweak/install. The script should also help new Ubuntu users, since it configures a lot of things automatically. Here's a partial list of the script's package-related help:

- Adds extra repositories: Ubuntu restricted, extras, Medibuntu, Getdeb, Dropbox (if you choose to install Dropbox)
- Installs (per your choice) The GIMP, Pidgin, WINE, Chromium browser, Gnome Do, Guake, VLC media player, Mplayer, SMplayer, Thunderbird, Dropbox, multimedia codecs, Java, Flash, additional archive formats support, DVD support and fonts, Ubuntu Tweak, Deluge Torrent, CompizConfig Settings Manager, development tools, etc.

The script also offers a 'Tweaks' screen with choices to:

- Move window buttons to the right (Karmic style)
- Change Update Manager behaviour to the one in Jauntu
- Remove mounted drive icons from desktop
- Disable GDM login sound and the user list
- Enable icons in menus and buttons
- Remove the *ubuntu-docs* package (frees up 252MB)
- Change the Gnome Calendar's first day of the week from Sunday to Monday
- Download, install and configure sharp fonts
- Fix 'apt-get update' delay for Google repository
- Automatically mount NTFS drives on startup

The latest version also fixes lots of bugs. If you're interested, visit <http://bit.ly/ce6ghit> for the full details and a download link.

Groklaw on the recent IBM-TurboHercules spat

There was a recent outburst on the Net about how IBM was supposedly breaking its pledge to not sue an open source project for infringement of 500 listed patents. Groklaw's PJ posted her reasoning on the matter. Here are some excerpts:

IBM, when it announced the patent pledge, specifically reserved the right to defend itself from attack [...] And in the TurboHercules story, who is suing whom? It's not IBM, folks. The complaint against IBM was filed with the EU Commission by TurboHercules. At that exact moment, did they not take themselves out from under the patent pledge's safety umbrella? So be it. Meanwhile, IBM's Dan Frye has reiterated its patent pledge in an email published on the Linux Foundation Executive Director Jim Zemlin's blog. [...] Here's the [partial] text:

[...]

IBM stands by this 2005 Non-Assertion Pledge today as strongly as it did then. IBM will not sue for the infringement of any of those 500 patents by any Open Source Software.

[...]

Personally, I think they absolutely are free from the pledge with respect to TurboHercules.

For more, head to: <http://bit.ly/csCwiA>.



GNU Compiler Collection 4.5 released

GCC developers have announced the release of version 4.5 of the GNU Compiler Collection under GPLv3. In addition to a number of bug fixes, the release features improved experimental support for the upcoming ISO C++ standard, C++0x, including support for raw strings, lambda expressions and explicit type conversion operators. Integration with the MPC library allows GCC to more accurately evaluate complex arithmetic during optimisation. (GCC now requires the MPC library in order to build.)

New target platforms include: ARM Cortex-M0 and Cortex-A5 processors; the ARM v7E-M architecture, and MIPS 1004K processors. More at <http://bit.ly/8YtjHl> and <http://bit.ly/cLCBET>.

What the judge still has to decide in SCO vs Novell

The jury in SCO vs Novell decided that SCO didn't get the copyrights under the APA or Amendment 2, which put paid to SCO's slander of the title claim as well. However, there are still some issues left to decide, according to Groklaw. The most important is SCO's claim for specific performance—even if it were decided that SCO didn't get the copyrights to date, under the APA, Novell is "obligated to turn them over now." More at: <http://bit.ly/bVgfj5>.

